Year 5 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y05/Y05_Student_Paper_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y05_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For staff only. Use with the Year 5 student paper (`Y05/Y05_Student_Paper_v3.1`), the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`) and the Interviewer guide for Years 5 and 6 (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y5_Y6`). The whole process, the English proficiency bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

Who this is for. Students joining UK Year 5 (age 9 to 10 in September). A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 3** (三年级); a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 4. The maths tests UK Year 4 content, with a few easier and a few harder items. The science tests UK Year 4 science and working scientifically.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student needs	Student paper pages
1	Welcome	2	Assessor (2.2)		1 (cover)
2	Listening (recording)	about 7	Assessor plays the recording or reads the script (3.1)	pencil	2 to 3
3	Reading paper, Parts A, B and C	12	Student alone; assessor keeps time (3.2)	pencil	4 to 9
4	Writing	10	Student alone (3.3)	pencil	10 to 11
	Break	3 to 5		water	
5	Maths	18	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (4)	pencil, rubber, ruler; no calculator, no protractor	12 to 17
6	Science	8	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (5)	pencil	18 to 21
7	Interview, opening with the sentence reading screen (start at **Level 4**)	12	Interviewer, 1:1 (3.4, 3.5)	sentence reading card; a plain card to cover sentences	
	Total student time	**about 67**, plus the break			

For each candidate:

- the student paper (21 pages, A4, printed at actual size: switch off "fit to page", because the diagrams and the type sizes depend on it);
- the grading sheet (`Y05/Y05_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 5 and 6 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y5_Y6`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y5_Y6`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`), laminated;
- a clock or timer, spare pencils;
- the listening recording (`audio/v3.1/Y05/`) and something to play it on.

The written papers can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; listening is played or read to the group; the interview is always 1:1.

Marks at a glance: listening / 8, reading / 24, writing / 16, maths / 25 (number problems / 10, word problems and pictures / 15, of which word problems / 5), science / 10.

2. Before you start

2.1 Set up

- A quiet, bright room. The student sits where they cannot see other students' papers.
- Write the student's name on the paper if they cannot (in English, with the Chinese name in brackets if the family uses one).
- Have these instructions open at 3.1 for the listening script (if you are not playing the recording), and a timer ready.

Pace of speech. Year 5 students are still learning English: speak a little slower than normal speech, about 140 words a minute. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

2.2 Welcome (say this)

> "Hello, I am [your name]. Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and plan how to help you. Some parts are easy and some parts are hard. That is fine. Do your best. If you do not understand what to do, you can ask me to say it again."

Show the cover page. Point to the "How to answer" examples and say: "Look. You tick a box, write in a box, circle, join with a line, and show your working like this."

2.3 Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English parts (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts or reading questions aloud. The student may ask for instructions to be repeated in English.	Read any question aloud in English, at the pace in 2.1, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0, and the grading sheet lists the NT topics.

Extra time or a reader for a known need is allowed: record it on the grading sheet. The number of **L** questions is evidence about English and goes on the grading sheet.

2.4 Stopping rules

- In every part, a student may stop when they have done what they can. Encourage once ("Have a look at the next one; some are easier"), then accept their decision.
- **Listening:** always play the whole recording, or read the whole script twice, even if the student writes nothing.
- **Reading:** let the student work for the full 12 minutes. Stop early only if the student has answered nothing in Part A after 4 minutes, or is upset; record "stopped after 4 minutes" on the Reading front sheet.
- **Writing:** if the student cannot start, say once: "You can write words, or draw and label your plan." Never write for them.
- **Maths and science:** stop at the time. A student who is stuck may be told: "You can go on to the next question."
- A distressed child is never pressed: stop, take a break or end the session, and record it on the grading sheet.

2.5 Keeping the student at ease

- Sit beside rather than opposite if you can. Smile, use the student's name, and praise effort ("Thank you, you are working hard"), not answers.
- Do not show marks or say whether an answer is right.
- Say how many parts are left. Offer water and the break after the writing.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 7 minutes with the recording, / 8)

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y05/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. It says the instructions below, reads the eight questions aloud once, plays the script twice (20 seconds apart) and gives one minute to finish, so you do not say or read anything yourself. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of the script takes about 1 minute 34 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

Say: "Turn to page 2. I am going to read a message from a teacher, Mr Chen, to his class. First I will read the questions to you. Then I will read the message two times. You can answer while I read. Answer on pages 2 and 3."

Read the questions aloud once, slowly, pointing to each number. Do not name or explain the pictures.

> "Question 1. How will the class travel to the museum? Tick one box. Question 2. What time does the bus leave school? Tick one box. Question 3. What must the children bring? Tick two boxes. Question 4. What will the class visit first? Tick one box. Question 5. How many children will be in each group? Question 6. How much does the trip cost? Question 7. Mr Chen says, 'Don't worry if it rains.' Why does he say this? Question 8. Will the children buy lunch at the museum? Tick yes or no. How do you know?"

Say: "Now listen. I will read the message two times."

Read it twice at about 140 words a minute, a little slower than normal speech. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, wait 20 seconds, then say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish.

Mr Chen: Good morning, everyone. I have some news about our class trip. [pause]

Next Thursday, we are going to the City Science Museum. We will go there by bus. The bus leaves school at half past eight, so please be at school by a quarter past eight. [pause]

Please wear your sports clothes and comfortable shoes, because we will walk a lot. Bring a water bottle and a packed lunch. You do not need to bring any money on the day. [pause]

At the museum, we will visit the space room first. After that, we will go to the robot workshop. There, you will build a small robot in groups of four. [pause]

The trip costs forty yuan. Please ask your parents to pay by Monday. [pause]

We will be back at school at three o'clock. And don't worry if it rains. Everything at the museum is inside. [pause]

I am sure it will be a great day.

Answers. 1 mark each. Spelling and grammar are not marked in listening; the answer must be in English and the meaning must be clear.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept	What it tests
1	**A** bus			key word
2	**B** 8:30		A 8:15 (the time to arrive at school)	a time; "half past"
3	**A** water bottle and **C** lunch box	both ticked and nothing else	money (they were told not to bring it), umbrella	two details; a negative ("do not need")
4	**A** space		B robots (that is second)	order words: "first", "after that"
5	**4**	four		number
6	**40**	¥40, 40 yuan, forty	14 (fourteen and forty sound alike)	number
7	Everything at the museum is inside, so the rain does not matter	"inside"; "they are inside"; "they will not get wet"	"it rains"; "bring an umbrella"	inference: links two sentences
8	**No**, because they bring a packed lunch, or because they do not need money	No with either reason; a reason without the tick if the meaning is clear ("no, they bring lunch")	Yes; No with no reason or a wrong reason	inference

Band guide

Score	0 to 2	3 to 4	5 to 6	7	8
Listening band	**A**	**B**	**C**	**D**	**E**

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 4 need key words and pictures only. A student who gets these but none of 5 to 8 usually knows familiar words but cannot yet follow connected speech (band B).
- The distractors in 2 (8:15) and 3 (money) show whether the student hears the words around a key word ("be at school by", "do not need").
- Questions 7 and 8 need two ideas linked: they separate D from E.
- Compare with "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet.

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, / 24)

Say: "Turn to page 4. This is the reading. There are three parts: A, B and C. Read the texts and answer the questions. Part C is hard. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. I cannot help you with the words, but I can say the instructions again. You have 12 minutes."

Start the timer. Say "Two minutes left" at 10 minutes and "Please stop" at 12 minutes. Do not read any text or question aloud and do not explain words.

Marking. Spelling is not marked unless the word cannot be recognised. For "find and copy" the word must be the right word from the text; a small copying slip is fine. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: the park notice (questions 1 to 6, / 8)

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Notes
1	1	8:00		18:00 is the closing time
2	2	swings, picnic, feed ducks	Score = correct ticks minus wrong ticks: 3 gives 2 marks, 2 gives 1 mark, 1 or less gives 0	The pictures match the notice; the skill is "you can" against "please do not"
3	1	¥2	2, 2 yuan	
4	1	at the café	cafe, the cafe, café shop	"the office", "the shop" (not in the text)
5	2	swim in the lake: **False**; open on Sundays: **True**	1 mark each	"Sundays" needs the reader to use "every day"
6	1	the office by the main gate	office; main gate; gate office	the café

Part B: Silkworms (questions 7 to 14, / 8). A text about two years below age level.

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
7	1	smaller than a grain of rice		
8	1	10	ten; about ten	4 (weeks), 2 (weeks)
9	1	black		white (the grown silkworm)
10	1	mulberry leaves	mulberry; leaves from a mulberry tree	"leaves" on its own
11	1	They eat a lot.		
12	1	cocoon	cocon, cocoon (small copying slips)	thread, silk
13	1	Boxes read **2, 4, 1, 3** (silkworm 2, moth 4, eggs 1, cocoon 3)	all four correct for the mark	
14	1	silk	silk clothes	"clothes" on its own

Part C: The Snowman at the Window (questions 15 to 22, / 8). Age-appropriate fiction for a fluent reader of 9.

Q	Marks	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
15	1	retrieval	the biggest snowman in the building	the biggest snowman; a big snowman; a snowman	"a snowball"
16	1	retrieval	Her legs were not strong any more.	her legs are weak; she could not walk on the ice; she might fall	"it was cold"; "she was watching the snow"
17	1	vocabulary	silent		soft; quiet (not in the paragraph)
18	1	vocabulary in context	breathing fast and hard		
19	1	inference	She was lonely and a little sad.		

Q	Marks	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
20	1	inference with evidence	happy (or surprised, delighted), because she laughed, or pressed her hand against the window, or her face changed	any suitable feeling with a reason from the story	a feeling with no reason; "sad"
21	1	inference	So that Mrs Zhao could see it from her window	to make her happy; because she could not go outside to see the snow; it was a present for her	"because the snowball was too heavy"
22	1	why do you think	It made Mrs Zhao happy: it was for someone else, and being kind matters more than being the biggest	any answer about kindness, making someone happy or thinking of others	"it had a scarf"; "it was smaller" with no reason

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C** Developing competence
Part C 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part C 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example, Part C higher than Part B), and check against the sentence reading screen. Record the reading paper marks and the reading band on the **Reading front sheet** and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Picture support.** A student who scores only on questions 1, 2 and 5 may be using the pictures, not the words.
- **Copying.** In Parts B and C, a pattern of copying words that sit next to the question words (for example "small insects" for question 7) suggests word matching without understanding.
- **Inference.** Questions 20 to 22 separate D from E. A student at band C often gets the retrieval questions and leaves the "why" questions blank.
- **Speed.** A student who is accurate but does not reach Part C may decode slowly: check the fluency rating from the sentence reading screen (Reading front sheet) before giving a low band.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, / 16)

Say: "Turn to page 10. This is the writing. Choose A or B, and tick the one you choose. You can plan in the box on page 11, then write on the lines. Write as much as you can. You have 10 minutes."

The task. A: a story about a child who finds a message in a bottle on a beach (picture and question prompts). B: "My favourite place", a description with question prompts. Both give a fair chance to show narrative or descriptive writing; do not give a higher mark for either choice.

Criteria. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 sit between the descriptions). Total: 16 marks.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or only words copied from the page	A few connected ideas on the topic in a simple order; may be short (3 to 5 sentences) or a list	A complete piece that fits the task: a story with an opening, a problem and an ending, or a description with several developed points; ideas link across sentences; paragraphs or clear sections
Vocabulary	No English words, or single words not on the topic	Everyday words that carry the meaning; a few topic words; much repetition (nice, good, big)	Varied, precise words for a 9 year old: chosen verbs, adjectives and adverbs; some ambitious words used correctly

Criterion	0	2	4
Grammar and sentences	No sentences	Simple sentences with mostly correct word order, joined with and, then, because; frequent errors in tense, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear	Different sentence types (with when, if, because, so, after); tense kept consistent; errors are rare and do not affect meaning
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling cannot be read; no punctuation	Common words mostly correct, others spelt as they sound; capital letters and full stops sometimes	Most words correct, including less common ones; full stops and capitals secure; commas, question marks and speech marks mostly correct

The writing band is given by best fit with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, not by the total alone. As a rough guide only: totals of 0 to 3 usually fit **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E at this age. A fluent writer of 9 to 10 usually writes about 100 to 180 words in 10 minutes. The piece has an opening and an ending, is in paragraphs or clear sections, uses some varied sentences ("When she opened the bottle, ...", "Suddenly, ..."), descriptive words, and in a story some speech with speech marks (not always correct). Common words are spelt correctly and harder words are spelt plausibly. The errors are the ones any 9 year old makes, not the features of a learner of English (missing "a" and "the", missing past tense -ed or plural -s, Chinese word order).

What to look for

- **Learner features** (missing -s, -ed, articles; "I very like") point to C or D even when the content is good.
- **Memorised chunks** ("My name is ... I am 9 years old. I like ...") with little else usually fit B.
- **A full plan and little writing** may mean slow writing in English rather than no ideas: say so in the notes on the grading sheet.

3.4 Speaking: the interview (about 8 minutes of questions)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y5_Y6` and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y5_Y6`). The interviewer records the speaking band and "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet, and speaks at the pace in 2.1. If the listening task (3.1) and listening in conversation differ by more than one band, note why on the Interview sheet (for example, the student relies on gesture and context in conversation).

3.5 Reading aloud: the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (opens the interview, 3 to 4 minutes)

Use `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`. The rules, the interviewer's copy of the sentences and the meaning questions, and the reading age table are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the record is the **Reading front sheet**. **Start at Level 4 (sentence 10)** for Year 5. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Follow the guide's rules for going back, stopping and the meaning checks. Use the "Years 3 to 5" column of the guide's reading age table to turn the reading age into an indicative band, and use it to confirm the reading paper band.

4. Maths (18 minutes, / 25)

Say: "Turn to page 12. This is maths. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and pictures. You can use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 18 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 4 content, with easier floor items (Year 3) and ceiling items (Year 5). Section A, number problems: 10 marks. Section B, word problems and pictures: 15 marks, of which **word problems: 5 marks** (questions 10, 12, 13 and 19b). Every Section B question has a picture, chart, table or diagram.

Marking. Give the mark for a correct answer with or without working. Units are printed in the answer boxes, so they are not needed. Accept answers in a different but correct form unless the question asks for a particular form.

4.1 Section A: number problems (/ 10)

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught (Chinese Grade 3 completed)
1	Add 3-digit numbers (Y3, floor)	1	594		584, 514: carrying slips	
2	Times table (Y3, floor)	1	56			
3	Subtract 4-digit numbers with exchange (Y4)	1	3 264	3264	4 744: subtracts the smaller digit from the larger in each column; 3 364: exchange slip	
4	12 times table (Y4)	1	72		62	The 11 and 12 times tables are often not learnt (tables go to 9 × 9). A student who works it out (10 × 6 + 2 × 6) is reasoning well.
5	3-digit × 1-digit (Y4)	1	972		962, 872: forgets a carried digit	
6	Hundredths as a decimal (Y4)	1	0.47	.47	4.7, 47.0, 0.047	Grade 3 meets tenths, often through money; hundredths are usually Grade 4.
7	Equivalent fractions (Y4)	1	9		3, 11: adds or copies the numerator	Equivalent fractions (分数的基本性质) are usually Grade 5.
8	Round to 10, 100 and 1 000 (Y4)	2	4 360; 4 400; 4 000	2 marks: all three; 1 mark: two correct	4 300 for the nearest 100: cuts off the digits instead of rounding	Rounding to the nearest 10, 100, 1 000 (四舍五入) is usually Grade 4, with large numbers; estimation (估算) is met earlier.
9	2-digit × 2-digit (Y5, ceiling)	1	864		216: multiplies by 2 instead of 20 in the second row	Usually taught in Grade 3 (两位数乘两位数), so many students will get this.

4.2 Section B: word problems and pictures (/ 15)

W = word problem.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
10 W	Division in context (Y3, floor)	1	12 tables	12	104 (adds), 88 (subtracts): did not understand "each"	
11	Bar chart with a scale in 5s (Y3 and Y4)	2	(a) 35 (b) 15	1 mark each	(a) 30 or 40: reads to the wrong line; (b) 45 (adds) or 30 (reads Thursday only)	Bar charts with a scale are often Grade 4; simple tables are Grade 2.
12 W	Measures: m to cm, subtraction (Y4)	1	135 cm	1 m 35 cm	1.35 (works in metres but the box says cm: 0, note it), 145, 265 (adds)	

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
13 W	Money, two steps (Y3 and Y4)	2	¥117	2 marks: 117. 1 mark: 133 (85 + 48) or 165 (250 – 85) seen with no correct second step, or a correct method with one arithmetic slip	383 (adds everything)	
14	Area by counting squares and perimeter (Y3 and Y4)	2	(a) 14 cm² (b) 22 cm	1 mark each; units not needed	(a) 18: counts the gap; (b) 18: misses the edges inside the gap; 14 for (b): confuses perimeter with area	Area and perimeter are Grade 3, so these should be familiar.
15	Acute, obtuse and right angles (Y4)	1	A obtuse, B acute, C right	all three for the mark; spelling not marked	C acute: the right angle is drawn turned, so the student must judge it, not rely on horizontal and vertical lines	Angle types (锐角, 钝角, 直角) are Grade 2; the English words may be new.
16	Types of triangle and quadrilateral (Y4)	1	A isosceles triangle, B parallelogram, C trapezium	all three joins correct	B and C swapped	The shapes are usually Grade 4 (三角形; 平行四边形和梯形); the English names may be new. A Chinese reading of the question names the shapes, so mark L.
17	Complete a symmetric shape (Y4)	1	The right half mirrors the left. From the top of the mirror line, a slanted line goes to the point 3 squares right and 3 squares down; then 1 square back towards the line; then 2 squares down; then 2 squares along the bottom back to the line. The finished shape is an arrow pointing up.	Small drawing inaccuracy if every corner is in the right square; shading not needed	A copy slid across instead of a mirror image	Line symmetry is often met in Grade 2; it may not have been practised on a grid.
18	Coordinates and translation (Y4)	2	(a) (3, 6) (b) (7, 4)	1 mark each; (b) follow-through: if (a) is wrong, award (b) for their point moved 4 right and 2 down	(6, 3): reverses the order; (b) (–1, 8) or (7, 8): wrong direction	Coordinates are usually Grade 7. Some textbooks use number pairs (数对: column, then row) in Grade 5, which is the same order as (x, y).

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
19	Negative numbers on a thermometer (Y4; (b) is a Y5 ceiling item)	2	(a) –4 °C (b) 3 °C; (b) is a word problem	1 mark each; "minus 4", "4 below zero"	(a) 4: no minus sign; (b) 11 (adds 4 and 7), –11, –3 (counts the wrong way)	Negative numbers are usually Grade 6. Students from northern China often know "零下" temperatures from weather reports.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 25	0 to 9	10 to 14	15 to 21	22 to 25
Maths band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

List the NT questions on the grading sheet and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

Topics that may not have been taught to a student who has completed Chinese Grade 3: the 11 and 12 times tables (4), hundredths (6), equivalent fractions (7), rounding (8), bar charts with a scale (11), the names of triangles and quadrilaterals (16), coordinates (18) and negative numbers (19). Calculation (1 to 3, 5, 9), measures, money, area and perimeter (10, 12 to 14) are usually taught by the end of Grade 3. Textbooks differ (PEP, 苏教版, 北师大版), so always ask the student.

4.3 What to look for

- **Number problems against word problems.** A student who scores well on number problems (Section A) but poorly on the word problems (10, 12, 13, 19b) may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. Check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the answer then comes quickly, record it as an English barrier on the grading sheet.
- **Method.** Students from Chinese schools often calculate quickly and accurately in their heads or in neat columns. A correct answer without working is fine. Look at the working when an answer is wrong: one slip in a sound method is a different need from a wrong method.
- **Conventions.** Reading a scale in 5s, "Not drawn accurately", coordinates in brackets and the UK names of shapes may be new. A student who shows the maths correctly with a picture or working knows the maths, even if the English words are new.

5. Science (8 minutes, / 10)

Say: "Turn to page 18. This is science. Every question has a picture. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 8 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 4 science and working scientifically. Question 7 is the fair test and table question.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers	May not have been taught
1	Solids, liquids and gases (Y4)	1	A solid, B liquid, C gas	all three for the mark, in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0	"ice" or "water" written in the box: describes, does not classify	The states of water (水的三态) are often taught by Grade 3, but the English words may be new.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers	May not have been taught
2	Teeth (Y4)	1	incisor: cuts food; canine: tears food; molar: chews and crushes food	all three joins correct	incisor and canine swapped	Teeth and digestion are often Grade 4.
3	Classification key (Y4)	1	A beetle, B earthworm	both; spelling not marked ("bettle", "earth worm")	A spider: did not count the legs (6)	Branching keys are less common in Chinese textbooks.
4	Food chains (Y4)	2	(a) rice plant → grasshopper → frog → snake (b) more grasshoppers	1 mark each; (a) accept "rice"; all four in order	(a) reversed (snake first): knows who eats whom but not the arrow convention, note it; (b) fewer	Food chains are often Grade 5.
5	Sound comes from vibration (Y4)	1	The top of the drum vibrates.		"The stick hits the rice."	Sound is usually Grade 4, so may not have been taught; the rice on a drum is a common Chinese classroom demonstration.
6	Circuits; conductors and insulators (Y4)	2	(a) B (b) metal paper clip	1 mark each	(a) C: thinks a switch always lets electricity through; (b) any other: does not link metal with conducting	Simple circuits are usually Grade 4, so may not have been taught.
7	Evaporation: reading a table, fair test (Y4, working scientifically)	2	(a) A sunny window (b) any one: the same amount of water at the start; the same size or kind of dish; the same time (2 days); measure in the same way	1 mark each; (b) "same water", "same dish", "same cup"	(a) C fridge: chooses the largest number, check that the student read "water after 2 days"; (b) "same place" or "same temperature" (those are what changes)	Fair testing in this form is less familiar; evaporation (蒸发) is often taught by Grade 3.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 10	0 to 3	4 to 5	6 to 8	9 to 10
Science band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

What to look for

- **Working scientifically.** Question 7 shows scientific thinking separately from topic knowledge. A student who gets 7 right but marks other questions NT is likely to do well once taught.
- **An English barrier** looks like wrong answers that depend on a single English word (solid, liquid, gas in 1; beetle in 3; vibrates in 5) while the picture questions (4, 6) are right. Reading the question aloud, or once in Chinese (L), usually settles it.
- **Everyday ideas** (for example "the stick hits the rice") are a science misconception, not an English problem.

6. Recording the results

1. Mark the student paper (every question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet (`Y05_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). In maths, also record on the grading sheet whether the number problems against the word problems (Section A / 10, word problems / 5) show an English barrier in maths: yes, no or unsure (see 4.3).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet.
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student paper with them (or shred it under the school's policy).

Interviewer guide: Years 5 and 6

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y5_Y6`).

About 12 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 4 minutes; start Level 4 for Year 5, Level 5 for Year 6; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Smile, sit beside rather than opposite the child if you can, and start with something easy. Ask the main question first. If the child struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak slowly and clearly: about 140 words a minute in Year 5 and about 155 in Year 6. Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a child tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions (8 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me about yourself and your family.	What is your name? Do you have a brother or sister?	What do you like doing together as a family?
	What did you do last weekend?	Did you go out or stay at home?	What was the best part, and why?
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is one thing you would change about it?
	What do you find hard at school? What do you do then?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you learnt something hard.
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read English books?	What helps you remember new words?
	How do you feel about having all your lessons in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What do you think will be hardest?
Interests	What do you like to do after school and at weekends?	Do you like sport, music, art or games?	What are you best at, and how did you get good at it?
	Tell me about a book, film or game you like.	Do you like reading?	Why do you like it? Who would you recommend it to?
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about it?
Friends and feelings	Tell me about your friends.	Do you have a best friend?	What makes someone a good friend?
	What do you do when you feel sad or worried?	Who do you talk to?	
	How do you feel about starting a new school?	Are you happy, nervous, or both?	What would help you settle in?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to be when you grow up? Why?	Do you have a dream job?	What do you need to learn to do that job?
	Is there a place in the world you would like to visit or live in?	China or another country?	What do you think it would be like?
	Why do you want to come to our school?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope to learn here?
Values (choose one)	Your friend breaks a classmate's pencil and says nothing. What do you do?	Is that OK?	Why?
	A new student cannot speak your language and sits alone. What do you do?	Would you play with them?	How could you help them?
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?	

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, for a child of this age, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the child is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single words and memorised phrases. Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported with pictures or gesture.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences about familiar things (family, school, likes). Frequent errors. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with short connected sentences ("because", "and then", "but"). Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Everyday vocabulary.
D Competent	Talks easily and at some length, explains and gives examples, manages most stretch prompts. Occasional errors that rarely affect meaning.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet from what you saw and heard: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or what you saw.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age
Attitude to learning and resilience	Keen to learn, has a go, keeps trying when work is hard
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest, enjoys talking about ideas
Social and emotional readiness	Settles with a new adult, talks about friends, manages nerves, ready for a new school
Independence and self-management	Follows instructions, looks after belongings, can work alone for a short time, will ask for help
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and polite in the interview and the values question
Readiness for English-medium learning	Happy to try speaking English even with mistakes, interested in learning English

Boarding readiness (only if the child will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision, coordination)
- Wellbeing (for example anxiety, very heavy after-school workload, sleep)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the child's likely homeroom teacher meets them, they note first impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, a picture word book, seating near the teacher) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Aim for about 120 words a minute in Years 1 and 2, 120 in Year 3, 130 in Year 4, 140 in Year 5, 155 in Year 6, 160 in Year 7, 160 in Year 8, 175 in Year 9 and 185 in Year 10. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.